

Challenge 1 - Who attacked CorpLocal?

MD5 Checksum: File Integrity is good, Hash is correct.

```
(root@kali)-[/home/kali/Downloads]
# md5sum Who_attacked_CorpLocal.zip
f957af4c5a6cda8ef5a2049ead7b65a4 Who_attacked_CorpLocal.zip
More (optional)
(root@kali)-[/home/kali/Downloads]
```

Task 1 – Initial Access

Question: Which user was targeted?

Answer: user01@corp.local

Question: What was the name of the malicious attachment?

Answer: Invoice_Q1-2026.docm

Question: What evidence confirms it was opened?

Investigation Method:

- Opened mail_server.json
- Used search filters: .docm, invoice, attachment
- Identified suspicious phishing email

Then opened workstation_win10_user01.json

- Used search filters: WINWORD, Invoice_Q1-2026.docm
- Confirmed execution of malicious document

```
{
  "timestamp": "2026-04-03T10:00:00Z",
  "event": "DELIVERY: Email 'Please pay now! See attached Invoice_Q1-2026.docm' to user01@corp.local"
}
```

Figure 1: Mail server evidence showing phishing email delivery

```
{
  "timestamp": "2026-04-03T10:02:00Z",
  "event": "Process start: WINWORD.exe Invoice_Q1-2026.docm PID 5612"
},
```

Figure 2: Workstation evidence showing malicious document execution

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Task 2 – Malware Execution

Question: What command or process initiated the malicious download?

Answer:

PowerShell.exe Invoke-WebRequest

Investigation Method:

- Searched workstation_win10_user01.json
- Used search filters: powershell, Invoke-WebRequest

```
{  
  "timestamp": "2026-04-03T10:02:10Z",  
  "event": "Process start: Powershell.exe 'Invoke-WebRequest' PID 5613"  
},
```

Figure 3: PowerShell Invoke-WebRequest execution

```
"timestamp": "2026-04-03T10:02:20Z",  
"event": "Process start: Powershell.exe 'init.ps1' PID 5615"
```

Figure 4: Execution of downloaded payload init.ps1

Question: Which external domain served the malicious payload?

Answer:

umbrella-corporation.biz

Investigation Method:

- Opened proxy_logs.json
- Used search filters: init.ps1, http, https
- Identified malicious HTTP GET request

```
{  
  "timestamp": "2026-04-03T10:02:11Z",  
  "event": "HTTP GET https://umbrella-corporation.biz/init.ps1",  
  "user": "user01@corp.local",  
  "result": "GRANT"  
},
```

Figure 5: Proxy log showing malicious domain access

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Task 3 – Privilege Escalation

Question: What technique was used to escalate privileges?

Answer:

fodhelper.exe UAC bypass technique

Investigation Method:

- Opened workstation_win10_user01.json
- Used search filters: fodhelper, UAC
- Identified suspicious privilege escalation process

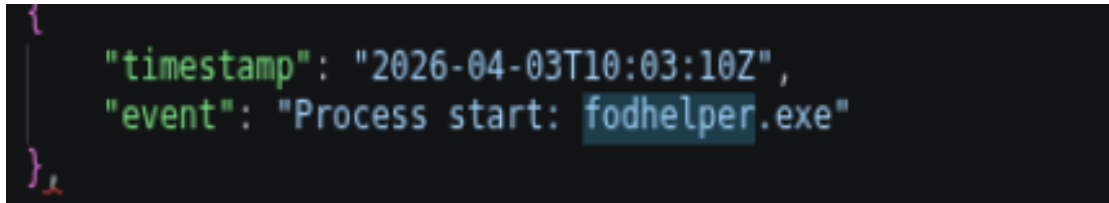


Figure 6: Privilege escalation evidence using fodhelper.exe

Task 4 – Lateral Movement

Question: Which internal servers were accessed?

Answer: SRV-FILE01 and DB01

Question: What method was used to move laterally?

The attacker likely used compromised administrative credentials after credential dumping activity.

Task 5 – Credential Dumping

Question: Identify any indications of tools.

Answer:

mimikatz.exe

Investigation Method:

- Opened srv_file01.json
- Used search filters: mimikatz, lsass
- Identified execution of credential dumping tool

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```
{  
  "timestamp": "2026-04-03T10:10:25Z",  
  "event": "Execution of mimikatz.exe detected on SRV-FILE01"  
},  
{
```

Figure 7: Credential dumping evidence with mimikatz.exe

Question: From which server were credentials extracted?

Answer: SRV-FILE01

Task 6 – Database Access Attempt

Question: Which account attempted to access the database server?

Answer: svc-admin

Question: Was the attempt successful?

Answer:

Yes. The database query executed successfully and no access denied message was observed.

Question: What queries were executed or attempted?

DB query: SELECT * FROM financial_records by svc-admin

Investigation Method:

- Opened srv_db01.json

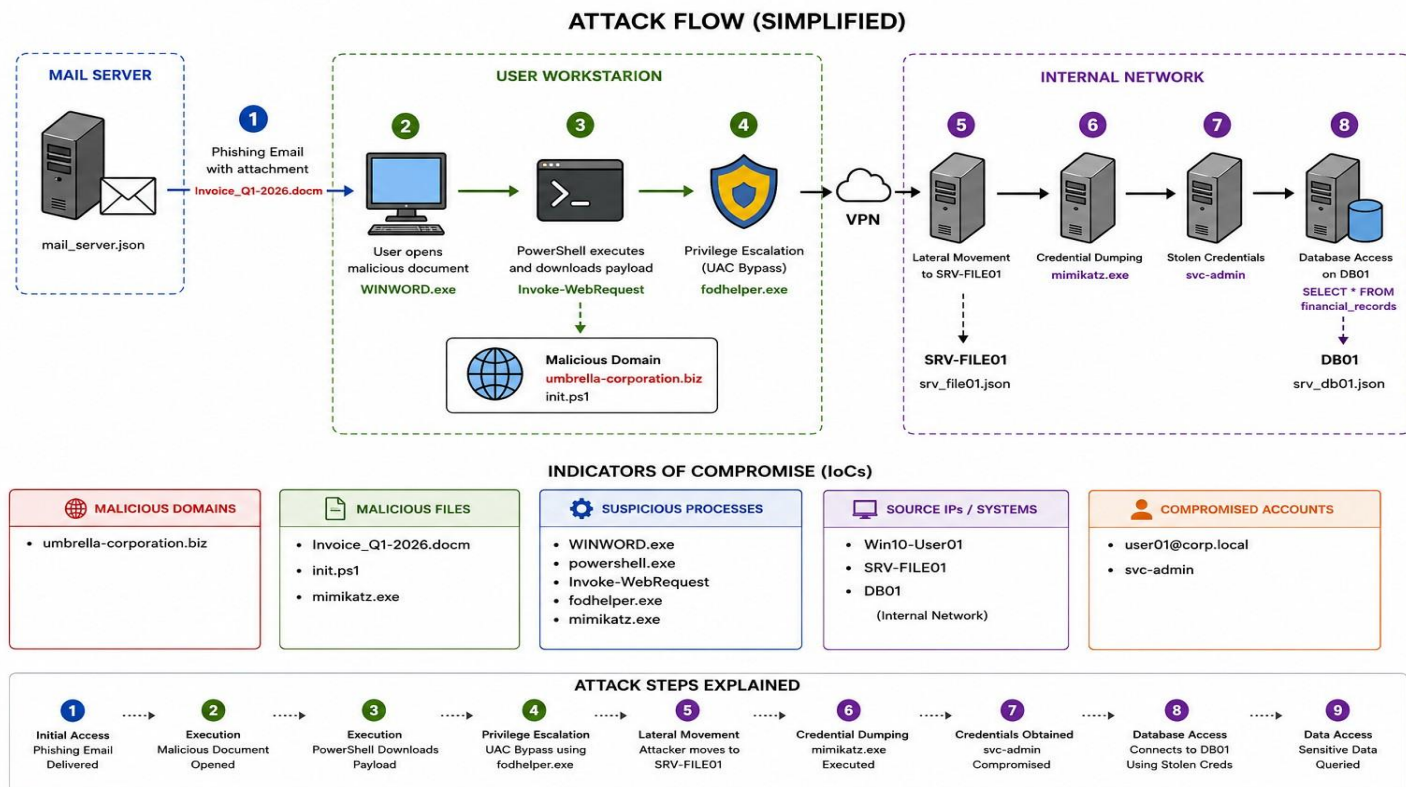
- Used search filters: SELECT, financial_records, svc-admin

```
{  
  "timestamp": "2026-04-03T10:25:00Z",  
  "client": "SRV-FILE01",  
  "event": "DB query: SELECT * FROM financial_records by svc-admin"  
}
```

Figure 8: Database access evidence using svc-admin

Task 7 – Indicators of Compromise (IoCs)

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Attack Timeline

Time	Event
10:00:00	Phishing email delivered
10:02:00	Malicious document opened
10:02:10	PowerShell Invoke-WebRequest executed
10:02:11	Payload downloaded
10:02:20	init.ps1 executed
10:03:10	fodhelper.exe privilege escalation
10:10:25	mimikatz.exe execution
10:25:00	Database access using svc-admin

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